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Section 60

Proposal

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Category: Bank

Subcategory: Hong Leong Bank

Title: Hong Leong Bank Financial Empowerment Hub for B40 Entrepreneurs

Introduction

A significant portion of the B40 community lacks access to formal financial services and literacy. They face challenges such as poor financial management, low savings rates and limited knowledge about banking tools and entrepreneurship.

This proposal is to establish a Financial Empowerment Program to enhance finance literacy by educating them on financial planning, savings, digital banking and entrepreneurship. Besides, providing them micro-financing access to start or expand small business.

Problem

Many B40 individuals lack understanding of banking, credit management and savings. This hinders their ability to make informed financial decisions. Besides, they may face difficulty in obtaining capital to start or sustain small business, as they lack credit history for loans. Therefore, they may be borrowing money from informal moneylenders. These contribute to income instability, limited upward mobility and economic inequality.

Solution

To address the problem, Hong Leong Bank Financial Empowerment Hub for B40 Entrepreneurs is proposed, providing financial literacy training and micro-banking access.

Financial literacy workshops will be conducted to teach budgeting, savings, credit management and digital banking using Hong Leong Connect. Besides, the program would facilitate account opening and introduce our target audience on micro-loan packages. On top of that, we provide mentorship and advisory sessions for B40 entrepreneurs to help them formalise their businesses, manage cash flow and grow sustainability. Finally, we are going to develop an online platform hosting education videos, budgeting tools and access to Hong Leong Bank's financial products.

Financial Justification

We request a RM200,000 grant to implement the program. The following is the financial breakdown along with the allocation of funds.

1. Training and workshop (RM60,000)
The fund will cover the cost of trainers, venue rentals and the development of educational materials.
2. Digital platform and resource hub development (RM30,000)
The fund covers the labour to develop the platform and the cost of implementing the platform.
3. Marketing (RM25,000)
The fund will cover marketing material printing, and digital marketing expenses.
4. Microfinance facilitation fund (RM40,000)

The fund will be used as seed funding or low-interest loans to 20 entrepreneurs to help them start their businesses.

5. Mentorship and advisory support (RM25,000)

The fund will cover the fees for mentors and business consultants.

6. Operational and administrative costs (RM20,000)

The fund will cover operational expenses necessary to run the program, including salaries for program coordinators, travel expenses, office supplies and administrative costs.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the initiative represents a powerful step towards building a more inclusive and financially empowered Malaysia. With the RM200,000 entrepreneurship grant support, the program will deliver long-term impact by improving financial literacy, enabling micro-financing and expanding banking access for the B40 population.